Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan

Dr. Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan (also indexed as Potre D. Diampuan) is a Maranao educator, scholar, peacebuilder, interfaith leader, and halal-policy practitioner from Mindanao, Philippines.

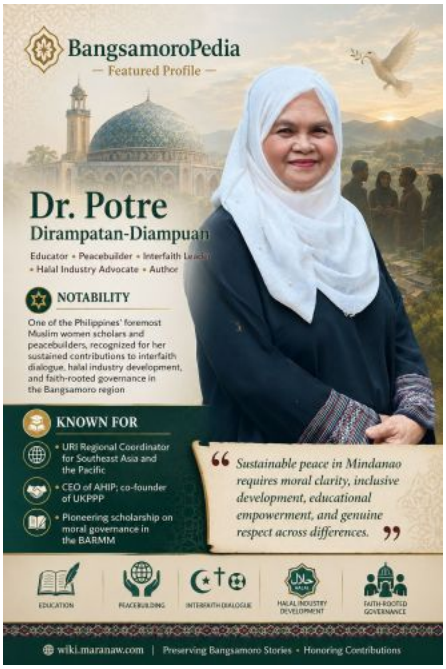
For decades she's worked where Islamic scholarship, education, governance, and community peace meet, and her record now includes a doctoral dissertation, university-published book chapters, a published policy essay, invited lectures, and a growing body of research that cites her work.

She serves as CEO of the Alliance for Halal Integrity in the Philippines Inc. (AHIP), served as a Global Council Trustee of the United Religions Initiative (URI) for Southeast Asia and the Pacific from 2018 to 2022, and co-authored a 2021 chapter that proposed five principles of moral governance for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM).

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Dr. Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan



Origin

Marawi City and the Lanao area, Mindanao, Philippines

Ethnicity

Maranao

Religion

Islam

Education

Ph.D. in Educational Management, Mindanao State University (MSU); M.A. in School Administration, MSU; M.A. in Cultural Anthropology, University of the Philippines; British Council Fellow, University of Durham, United Kingdom (2005)

Occupation

Educator, scholar, author, peacebuilder, interfaith leader, halal-policy practitioner

Affiliations

Alliance for Halal Integrity in the Philippines Inc. (AHIP); United Religions Initiative (URI); National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF, consultant); United Kingdom-Philippines Partners for Peace (UKPPP, co-founder)

BACKGROUND

Dr. Potre is rooted in Marawi City and the wider Lanao area, and her Maranao heritage sits at the center of her work.

That background isn't cultural decoration. It's the base for her thinking on Muslim identity, autonomy, and coexistence in a diverse and often tense archipelago.

After the 2017 Marawi siege, she spoke about the longing of displaced residents to rebuild their homes and lives with dignity.

Her own family's story includes displacement during past conflicts, and that lived experience has kept her wary of top-down "solutions" and committed to slower, trust-based work across faith lines.

Notable Works

Understanding Jihad (doctoral dissertation, 2006); "A Theoretical Study: Iran's Islamic Revolution and the Filipino People Power" (2017); "Principles and Practice of Moral Governance in the Bangsamoro" (2021); "Gaps in the Halal Industry in the Philippines" (2023)

Notability

Maranao educator and scholar whose five-principle framework for moral governance in the Bangsamoro has been cited in Bangsamoro Parliament research, international peacebuilding studies, and journal literature

Known For

Moral governance scholarship (with Dr. Nassef Manabilang Adiong); URI Regional Coordinator for Southeast Asia and the Pacific and Global Council Trustee (2018 to 2022); CEO of AHIP; advocacy for a Philippine Halal Authority

Pull Quote

Halal, in her framing, is about integrity "at every stage."

EDUCATION

She earned her Ph.D. in Educational Management from Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi City.

Her doctoral dissertation, *Understanding Jihad: Basis for Policy Formulation and Educational Programs for Muslims in the Philippines* (2006), is cataloged by the Philippine eLib under the subjects Jihad, Education and state, and Muslims, Education, Philippines.[1]

The study's analysis of greater (inner) and lesser (physical) jihad was later used in educational material on Islam and peace.[2]

She also holds a master's degree in School Administration from MSU and another in Cultural Anthropology from the University of the Philippines.

In 2005, she was a British Council Fellow at the University of Durham in the United Kingdom, an experience that broadened her view of peacebuilding and dialogue.

Her author biography in *Development for Peace* lists her writing interests as Muslim institutions in Philippine bureaucracy, sustainable peace, development, and governance.[3]

CAREER

Education and Peacebuilding in the Classroom

Dr. Potre treats education as a frontline tool for peace.

She's trained teachers to bring peacebuilding into everyday instruction, consulted on Muslim education initiatives for the Department of Education, and advised local government in Marawi.

A 2024 research article on women leaders in Mindanao highlights her peacebuilding work in curricula and teacher training.[4]

Scarboro Missions documented her use of the Golden Rule poster in peace-education and interfaith programs, including engagement with the Philippine Department of Foreign Affairs.[5]

Interfaith Leadership and the United Religions Initiative

The United Religions Initiative (URI) appointed her Regional Coordinator for Southeast Asia and the Pacific around 2012.

She later served as Senior Interfaith Advisor for the Philippines and as Global Council Trustee for Southeast Asia and the Pacific from 2018 to 2022.[6]

URI's 2013 to 2014 organizational review records her perspective on conflict, peace, and the Bangsamoro peace process as regional coordinator, and a 2018 "Every Voice" profile describes her interfaith philosophy.[7][8]

In 2012, she organized a United Nations International Day of Peace observance at a Taguig City mosque under the theme "Sustainable Peace for a Sustainable Future," which drew about 500 people.[9]

Her name also appears among Philippine participants in United Nations documentation for the 2011 Commission on the Status of Women (E/CN.6/2011/INF/1), though the record misprints her honorific.[10]

UK-Philippines Partners for Peace and the NCMF

She co-founded the United Kingdom-Philippines Partners for Peace (UKPPP) with other Mindanao scholars, backed by the British Council, to support peace efforts back home.

For the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF), she has consulted on peace programs and on preventing and countering violent extremism (PCVE).

Halal Industry Advocacy and AHIP

As CEO of AHIP, Dr. Potre pushes for stronger halal standards, education, certification, and regulatory frameworks.

Her point is simple: halal integrity has to hold at every stage, from raw materials to the finished product, and getting it right helps Muslim communities while opening doors for Philippine goods abroad.

In 2024, the Department of Trade and Industry (DTI) named her among the leaders of halal-certifying bodies who took part in a government-industry dialogue.[11]

A 2019 study on halal certification among non-halal restaurant owners in Manila also cites her as an AHIP authority on the regulatory setting.[12]

SCHOLARLY WORKS

Doctoral Dissertation (2006)

Understanding Jihad is her foundational academic work. It argues for policy and educational programs for Muslims in the Philippines grounded in a careful reading of jihad, and the 2021 moral governance chapter cites it.[1][3]

Iran's Islamic Revolution and Filipino People Power (2017)

In "A Theoretical Study: Iran's Islamic Revolution and the Filipino People Power," she compares six theoretical explanations of the Iranian Revolution with the Philippine People Power Revolution and maps where the two converge and diverge.

The chapter appears on pages 50 to 62 of *Philippine-Iran Relations: 50 Years and Beyond*, edited by H. A. Sevilla Jr. and published by the Asian Center, University of the Philippines Diliman.[13]

Moral Governance in the Bangsamoro (2021)

Co-authored with Dr. Nassef Manabilang Adiong, "Principles and Practice of Moral Governance in the Bangsamoro" appears on pages 31 to 53 of *Development for Peace*, edited by U. S. Malik and published by MSU-Marawi and Maven Media Asia.[3]

It's an exploratory, conceptual piece that asks how BARMM can move past secular "good governance" toward a faith-informed moral governance built on five linked principles: Faith, Freedom, Moral Authority, Common Good, and Social Ethics.

The framework draws on Islamic values while staying inclusive of Christians, Indigenous Peoples, and every other group in the region.

It also takes on BARMM's practical problems: corruption legacies from the old ARMM era, the need for merit-based systems, and accountable leadership.

Halal Policy Essay (2023)

On November 24, 2023, BusinessWorld published her essay "Gaps in the Halal Industry in the Philippines: Call for Legislating Philippine Halal Authority."

She argues for a dedicated national halal agency with both regulatory and development functions. It's a policy essay, not a peer-reviewed journal article, and it was also republished by HalalFocus.[14]

RECEPTION AND CITATIONS

Her work has traveled well beyond its original pages, and the moral governance chapter in particular has become a reference point in Bangsamoro governance discussions.

- The Bangsamoro Parliament's Policy Research and Legal Services (PRLS) paper on merit-based recruitment applies the five-principle framework to civil-service hiring and cites specific pages of the chapter for Faith, Moral Authority, Common Good, and Social Ethics.[15]
- A 2022 PRLS policy commentary, "How viable is moral governance?", treats the chapter as a foundational formulation of the concept.[16]
- The Berghof Foundation's study on implementing the Bangsamoro peace agreement identifies Adiong and Diampuan (2021) as researchers who define moral governance in Islamic religious terms.[17]
- The Institute for Autonomy and Governance's 2025 *Review of the BARMM Transition* cites the chapter in discussing moral governance as the centerpiece of the transition and its anti-corruption agenda.[18]
- A 2024 study titled *Locus and Maxims of Moral Governance: A Framework for the Bangsamoro Government* cites the chapter in framing BARMM's moral governance commitment.
- A 2025 study on moral governance and school heads' performance in the Bangsamoro Special Geographic Area (SGA) uses the chapter in its conceptual discussion.[19]
- A 2026 article in *Muslim Politics Review* on Aceh and Bangsamoro lists the chapter among its references.[20]

Her 2017 Iran chapter is also cited in a peer-reviewed article by H. A. Sevilla Jr. on Philippine-Iran relations in *Historia i Swiat* (2023), which discusses her comparison of the Iranian Revolution and Philippine People Power.[21]

Her dissertation also appears in the bibliography of the *Sampung Piling Salitang Meranao* and in the references of other indexed works.

SCHOLARSHIP ABOUT HER

The 2024 article "Emanating Change: Fragments of Micro-Empowerment Among Women Leaders in Mindanao, Philippines" studies twelve women leaders in the region, and Dr. Potre is one of them.

It treats her as a Meranaw educator and peacebuilder and discusses her peacebuilding in curricula and teacher training, her grassroots work, the UK-Philippines Partners for Peace, her British Council fellowship, and her interfaith leadership.[4]

LECTURES AND INTERFAITH CONTRIBUTIONS

- **"Revisiting the Narrative of Bangsamoro"** (January 27, 2022): an invited virtual lecture for the Policy Research and Legal Services of the Bangsamoro Parliament, covering Bangsamoro ethnolinguistic groups and identity, narratives and historicity of Muslims in the Philippines, and a chronicle of Muslim affairs.[22]
- **Muslim contribution to the Interfaith Forum on Laudato Si** (2016, Malate Parish, Manila): her intervention connected religion, human development, climate change, sustainability, and the interconnectedness of people and the planet.[23]
- **"Interfaith and the Future of Our Earth"** (2013, Pasay City): she hosted this URI Southeast Asia and the Pacific roundtable on how different faiths approach protecting the planet.[24]
- **"How I Came Into Interfaith"** (2014): she interviewed Dr. Noemi Medina for the URI Southeast Asia-Pacific archive, a documented oral-history contribution rather than a scholarly publication.[25]

LEGACY

Dr. Potre's career is a study in persistence and range.

She moves between university halls, interfaith forums, government offices, halal trade dialogues, and Maranao family gatherings, and she brings something substantive to each.

Her approach is rooted in faith and culture, practical about governance and development, and stubbornly hopeful about dialogue.

She continues to consult, write, speak, and lead AHIP, with one conviction running through all of it: lasting peace in Mindanao needs moral clarity, inclusive development, educational empowerment, and real respect across differences.

RECOGNITION

- British Council Fellow, University of Durham, United Kingdom (2005)
- URI Regional Coordinator for Southeast Asia and the Pacific (c. 2012)
- URI Senior Interfaith Advisor for the Philippines
- URI Global Council Trustee for Southeast Asia and the Pacific (2018 to 2022)
- Co-founder, United Kingdom-Philippines Partners for Peace (UKPPP)
- CEO, Alliance for Halal Integrity in the Philippines Inc. (AHIP)

SELECTED WORKS

- Diampuan, P. D. (2006). *Understanding jihad: Basis for policy formulation and educational programs for Muslims in the Philippines* [Doctoral dissertation, Mindanao State University, Marawi City].
- Diampuan, P. (2017). A theoretical study: Iran's Islamic Revolution and the Filipino People Power. In H. A. Sevilla Jr. (Ed.), *Philippine-Iran relations: 50 years and beyond* (pp. 50-62). Asian Center, University of the Philippines Diliman.
- Adiong, N. M., & Diampuan, P. D. (2021). Principles and practice of moral governance in the Bangsamoro. In U. S. Malik (Ed.), *Development for peace: In pursuit of sustainable peace through inclusive development, the case of the Bangsamoro* (pp. 31-53). Mindanao State University-Marawi and Maven Media Asia.
- Diampuan, P. D. (2023, November 24). Gaps in the halal industry in the Philippines: Call for legislating Philippine Halal Authority. *BusinessWorld*.

NAME VARIANTS

Her name appears in several spellings across catalogs and publications, and they all refer to the same person: Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan; Potre Dirampatan Diampuan; Potre D. Diampuan; Potre Diampuan; Potre Dirampaten-Diampuan; and Potre Diramptan-Diampuan (the form URI uses).

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